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MOTIONS TO COMPEL

The Court

tenders the following tentative decision in the matter Jacob Hall v. ASM Global, LLC, et al., Los Angeles County Superior Court case number 26STCV10698, set for hearing on September 16, 2026. Jacob Hall (Plaintiff) moves for orders compelling further responses to the following discovery requests propounded on ASM Global, LLC (Defendant): (1) form interrogatories, set one (FROGs); (2) requests for production of documents, set one (RFPs); (3) special interrogatories, set one (SPROGs); (4) requests for admissions, set one (RFAs); and (5) employment form interrogatories, set one (eFROGs). Plaintiff also requests a total \$8,250 in monetary sanctions. Defendant has not filed any opposition to the present motions. Plaintiff's motions to compel further responses are granted. The Court awards \$5,500 in sanctions.

A.

Legal Standard

A party may move for an order

compelling further responses to a request for production of documents if the propounding party deems that responses are incomplete, evasive, or contain meritless objections. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2031.310, subd. (a).) A motion to compel further responses to requests for production "shall set forth specific facts showing good cause justifying the discovery sought by the inspection demand." (Id., § 2031.310, subd. (b)(1).) A party may also move for an order compelling further responses to interrogatories if the propounding party deems that responses are incomplete, evasive, contain meritless objections, or improperly exercise the option to produce documents under section 2030.230. (Id., § 2030.300, subd. (a).) And a party may move for an order compelling

further responses to requests for admissions if it shows that an answer is evasive or incomplete or an objection is meritless. (Id., § 2033.290, subd. (a).)

“For discovery purposes, information is relevant if it ‘might reasonably assist a party in evaluating the case, preparing for trial, or facilitating settlement.’

[Citation]. Admissibility is not the test and information, unless privileged, is discoverable if it might reasonably lead to admissible evidence.

[Citation] These rules are applied liberally in favor of discovery.” (Gonzales v. Superior Court (1995) 33 Cal.App.4th 1539, 1546.) “If the court determines that the answer or production sought is subject to discovery, it shall order that the answer be given, or the production be made on the resumption of the deposition.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 2025.480, subd. (i).)

B. Discussion

Defendant served its responses to Plaintiff’s written discovery demands on May 26, 2026. (Toor FROGs Decl. ¶ 5.) Thereafter, Plaintiff determined that further responses were necessary because the responses included meritless objections. (Id. ¶¶ 6–7.) Plaintiff addressed these alleged deficiencies through meet and confer correspondence sent on June 19, 2026, requesting supplemental responses by June 26. (Id. ¶¶ 9, 11.) Defendant had not served any further responses as of the filing of this motion on July 2. (Id. ¶ 13.) Plaintiff moves to compel further responses to the following: (1) FROGs 1.1, 3.1–3.7, 4.1, 4.2, 12.1–12.3, 13.2, 14.1, 14.2, 15.1, and 17.1; (2) RFPs 1–40; (3) SPROGs 1–35; (4) RFAs 1–35; and (5) eFROGs 200.1–200.6, 201.1–201.7, 207.1, 207.2, 208.1, 208.2, 211.1–211.3, 214.1, 214.2, 215.1, 215.2, 216.1, and 217.1. The Court will address each discovery set in turn.

Defendant must provide further responses to FROGs 1.1, 3.1–3.7, 4.1, 4.2, 12.1–12.3, 13.2, 14.1, 14.2, 15.1, and 17.1.

Plaintiff moves to compel further responses to FROGs 1.1, 3.1–3.7, 4.1, 4.2, 12.1–12.3, 13.2, 14.1, 14.2, 15.1, and 17.1. A party may move for an order compelling a further response to an interrogatory if an answer to the interrogatory is evasive or incomplete, if the responding party improperly exercises its right to produce documents, or if

an objection to an interrogatory is without merit or too general. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (a).)

First, FROG 1.1 asks Defendant to identify those who assisted in the preparation of its responses to FROGs. Defendant objects to this FROG as vague or ambiguous. This FROG is standard and Defendant's objection is without merit; thus, a further response is warranted.

Second, FROGs 3.1–3.7 ask Defendant to identify basic business information such as its corporate status, whether it has done business under a fictitious name, and whether it has been licensed or registered by a public entity. Defendant objects to these FROGs as vague, overbroad, and irrelevant. These FROGs are standard and Defendant's objections are without merit; thus, further responses are warranted.

Third, FROGs 4.1 and 4.2 ask for insurance information. Defendant objects to these FROGs as vague regarding their definition of "incident," irrelevant, overbroad, and intruding on its privacy rights. Plaintiff defined "incident" to include an alleged adverse employment action, whistleblower retaliation, and the other claims in his complaint. This definition is sufficiently precise to allow for a response. Additionally, the FROGs are not overbroad or irrelevant, and Defendant has not identified a legally protected privacy interest with respect to its insurance information. Thus, Defendant's objections are without merit and further responses are warranted.

Fourth, FROGs 12.1–12.3 and 13.2 seek identifying information for those individuals who witnessed the incident, whether those individuals have been interviewed, whether written statements have been taken, and whether a written report has been prepared based on any surveillance. Defendant once again objects to the definition of "incident," which as discussed above is sufficiently precise. Defendant also objects to the FROGs as overbroad and violative of the attorney client privilege. But these FROGs seek basic information involving potential witnesses and do not require Defendant to turn over privileged material or protected work product. Thus, Defendant's objections are without merit and further responses are warranted.

Fifth, FROGs 14.1 and 14.2 seek information as to whether Defendant contends that any individual involved in the incident violated a statute, ordinance, or regulation, and whether they were cited for

the same. Defendant once again objects to the definition of “incident,” which as discussed above is sufficiently precise; thus, Defendant’s objections are without merit and further responses are warranted.

Sixth, FROGs 15.1 and 17.1 seek facts upon which Defendant’s denials of allegations, affirmative defenses, or responses to RFAs are based. Defendant objects to these FROGs as vague, overbroad, irrelevant, and violative of its privacy rights and the attorney-client privilege. However, these FROGs seek information relevant and specifically tied to Plaintiff’s claims. Additionally, Defendant does not identify a specific privacy right at issue or how the attorney client privilege is violated. Thus, its objections are without merit and further responses are warranted. Accordingly, Plaintiff’s motion to compel further responses to FROGs is granted in full.

Defendant must provide further responses to RFPs 1–40.

Plaintiff moves to compel further responses to RFPs 1–40. A party may move for an order compelling a further response to a RFP if a statement of compliance with a demand is incomplete, a representation of inability to comply is inadequate or evasive, or if an objection is without merit or too general. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2031.310, subd. (a).) Such a motion must set forth specific facts showing good cause justifying the discovery sought. (Id., § 2031.310, subd. (b)(1).) Plaintiff identifies the relevance of the RFPs in his motion, satisfying the good cause requirement. With respect to each request, Plaintiff identifies the objections levied by Defendant as too general. Indeed, Defendant objects to every RFP as insufficiently particularized, overbroad, violative of its privacy rights and the attorney client privilege, and seeking irrelevant information. These exact same objections are repeated with respect to every RFP, without any further substantiation. Thus, the objections levied with respect to the RFPs are too general, warranting further responses pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2031.310, subdivision (a)(3). Accordingly, Plaintiff’s motion to compel further responses to RFPs is granted in full.

Defendant must provide further responses to SPROGs 1–35.

Plaintiff moves to compel further

responses to SPROGs 1–35. A party may move for an order compelling a further response to an interrogatory if an answer to the interrogatory is evasive or incomplete, if the responding party improperly exercises its right to produce documents, or if an objection to an interrogatory is without merit or too general. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (a).) With respect to each SPROG, Plaintiff identifies the objections levied by Defendant as too general. Indeed, Defendant objects to every SPROG as vague and ambiguous, overbroad, violative of its privacy rights and the attorney client privilege, and seeking irrelevant information. These exact same objections are repeated with respect to every SPROG, without any further substantiation. Thus, the objections levied with respect to the SPROGs are too general, warranting further responses pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2030.300, subdivision (a)(3). Accordingly, Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to SPROGs is granted in full.

Defendant must provide further responses to RFAs 1–35.

Plaintiff moves to compel further responses to RFAs 1–35. A party may move for an order compelling a further response to a request for admission if an answer to a request is evasive or incomplete or an objection to a request is without merit or too general. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2033.290, subd. (a).) With respect to each RFA, Plaintiff identifies the objections levied by Defendant as too general. Indeed, Defendant objects to every RFA as vague and ambiguous, compound, and seeking irrelevant information. These exact same objections are repeated with respect to every RFA, without any further substantiation. Thus, the objections levied with respect to the RFAs are too general, warranting further responses pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2033.290, subdivision (a)(2). Accordingly, Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to RFAs is granted in full.

Defendant must provide further responses to eFROGs 200.1–200.6, 201.1–201.7, 207.1, 207.2, 208.1, 208.2, 211.1–211.3, 214.1, 214.2, 215.1, 215.2, 216.1, and 217.1.

Plaintiff moves to compel further responses to eFROGs 200.1–200.6, 201.1–201.7, 207.1, 207.2, 208.1, 208.2, 211.1–211.3, 214.1, 214.2, 215.1, 215.2, 216.1, and 217.1. A party may move for an order compelling a further response to an interrogatory if an answer to the interrogatory is evasive or incomplete, if the responding party improperly exercises its right to produce documents, or if an objection to an

interrogatory is without merit or too general. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (a).) With respect to each eFROG, Plaintiff identifies the objections levied by Defendant as too general. Indeed, Defendant objects to every eFROG as vague and ambiguous, compound, overbroad, violative of its privacy rights and the attorney client privilege, and seeking irrelevant information. These exact same objections are repeated with respect to every relevant eFROG, without any further substantiation. Thus, the objections levied with respect to the eFROGs are too general, warranting further responses pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2030.300, subdivision (a)(3). Accordingly, Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to eFROGs is granted in full.

Sanctions
are warranted.

Plaintiff requests sanctions in the total amount of \$8,250. Sanctions may be awarded where a party unsuccessfully opposes a motion to compel further responses to RFAs, RFPs, SPROGs, or FROGs, provided that the party does so without substantial justification. (Code Civ. Proc., §§ 2030.300, 2031.310, 2033.290.) The Court may award such sanctions even if no opposition to a motion is filed. (Rules of Court, rule 3.1348(a).) Here, Defendant opposed Plaintiff's motions without substantial justification, as it did not attempt to substantiate its objections. Thus, sanctions are warranted pursuant to sections 2030.300, 2031.310, and 2033.290.

Counsel testifies to an hourly rate of \$500, which the Court credits. (Toor FROGs Decl. ¶ 19.) Counsel alleges 3 hours spent preparing each motion and 1.5 total hours spent at the eventual hearing. (Ibid.) Taking into account counsel's alleged experience, the Court finds 2 hours per motion a more reasonable estimate and credits an additional hour for attendance at the hearing. Accordingly, the Court awards Plaintiff sanctions in the amount of \$5,500 $(\$500 \text{ per hour} \times [11 \text{ hours}] = \$5,500)$.

C. Conclusion

The Court grants Plaintiff's motions in full. Plaintiff is awarded \$5,500 in sanctions, payable by Defendant's counsel. Responses to discovery and payment of sanctions due in 30 days.